

Good morning Mr. Lim, Ms. Ong, Mrs. Tan, teachers, parents and fellow Peicaians, thank you for taking your time off on a Saturday morning to be here with us. My name is Thanathorn Sukprasert. I am the newly appointed president for 2016 to 2017. It is indeed an honour to be standing in front of all of you here to deliver my speech.

First of all, I would like to say thank you to all of you for the support and opportunities that were given to me. I wouldn't be able to stand right here, at this moment, without all your support. I would also like to specially thank my fellow Secondary Three leaders who were on the journey with me since we became student leaders when we were in Secondary One. In addition, I would like to express my heartfelt thanks to the outgoing executive committee as well as all my seniors for their great amount of hard work, effort and sacrifices that they have been contributing to the school for the past few years. Now, it is time for me, together with my student leaders to continue their legacy and create one of our own.

This year, the theme of our 8th student leaders' investiture is "Dare to lead". To me, daring to lead is to be courageous and be able to step up to make the difference. However, a difference cannot occur unless 'you' step up and create one. So we, as leaders, need to have the courage to step up and make the difference, to be brave enough to lead and not surrender to the fear of rejection when others disagree with your actions. It doesn't matter whether the difference that you have chosen to make is a big or small one. What matters more is that you take the chance, despite the possibility of failure, to do the right thing that you desire to achieve. It is the constant small actions that will make a big difference.

Of course, it is absolutely easier said than done and there is no shortcut or the easiest way for us to gain bravery overnight. It takes some time to build up. But many of us would give up half way through because we are only looking forward to 'instant' outcomes. Even I, myself, was almost like that at one point. But, thanks to the support from my teachers and peers, I gained courage and strength to persevere through each day to become a better leader than I was yesterday. So, keep in mind that everything that's worth anything is tough. Dedication and sacrifice is the start to gaining success. The ones who can pull through the tough times are the ones who will succeed eventually.

It is always easier for us to take a back seat and take instructions from others. However, I have chosen to pluck up my courage and take the lead rather than doing nothing and waiting for things to be improved and changed by itself because I believe that I can make a difference to our school. It is difficult for anybody to step out of their comfort zone. However, it is only when we step out of our comfort zone, will we be able to learn new things and build up our self-confidence. I have never imagined myself being the President of the student population when I first stepped into Peicai. It is the school, the teachers, and my fellow Peicaians who have brought me up to become who I am today. Thus, I am very thankful and so here I am, stepping out of my comfort zone to take on the position of the President to serve the school.

As the president, one of the first few things that I hope to achieve is to raise the commitment level of the student leaders. With higher level of commitment, more tasks can be completed with higher efficiency and quality and more things can be initiated to improve our school. I need all your help to work together as a family to make our school a better place for all Peicaians. We can then uphold our school name with pride and build a stronger sense of attachment to the school.

There is a saying, courage is like a muscle—the more you use it, the stronger it becomes. Our courage and confidence level may begin low. However, we gain courage and confidence overtime through every single experience in leading. I always believe that everyone has the potential to lead. It is just a matter of time that we are ready and of course more importantly, it is a matter of choice, whether to take on the leading role. My fellow student leaders, who do you want to be? Make your choice now.

Thank you.